PRODUCT DIRECTION / V0.1

One instrument. Two ways to explore.

A concept and decision dossier for the app team and engine agent. iPhone first; Android planned.

A complete free recorder with a physical front-and-back relationship: record simply on the front, then flip the instrument over to watch and explore the audio internals.

Recorder mode

A home for vintage-hardware and audio enthusiasts. Credible test-equipment styling, intuitive live recording, and an interior that makes the sound process visible.

Investigation mode

A dedicated field instrument with audio and synchronized phone sensor tracks. The theatrical visual direction can coexist with clearly labeled measurements.

A generous free foundation

Both modes, visible internals, and the engine's intended user adjustments belong in the free app. Exact adjustable controls await an engine inventory.

Paid expansion as an experience

Bundles introduce multiple complementary components and useful example chains. The goal is meaningful exploration without a sense of paying for every small control.

Status: Product direction agreed in conversation. Rendered controls, routing and readings are illustrative. This document does not certify implementation or hardware fidelity.

CONCEPT 01 / ACCEPTED VISUAL BASELINE

Recorder: front and exposed back

The original concept remains the visual baseline. Borrow the language of vintage hardware while giving the app its own identity.



Read: Simple record/play controls on the front; a stylized electronics interior with legible audio stages on the back. Keep recording state and Stop accessible in the interior. Stage names and knob settings are concept placeholders.

A theatrical field instrument

Ghost-hunting instrumentation with brass, glowing elements and steampunk influences; actual measurements stay distinct from atmosphere.



Read: Left: live capture and field measurements. Right: audio and sensor tracks reviewed at a shared moment. This is live/review, not a front/back pair. Investigation mode still retains the flip-to-internals interaction. Readings are fabricated for the concept.

VST character, designed for a phone

Distinct modules, tactile controls and responsive meters sit inside the removed-back-panel metaphor.



Read: Left: compact chain overview. Right: an added Reverb module expanded. Add, inspect, bypass and reposition are proposed interactions, pending engine support. Large controls and a persistent Stop button take priority over desktop-style density.

EXPERIENCE ARCHITECTURE

Modes, skins and the flip

Modes define the task

Recorder mode emphasizes the vintage audio experience. Investigation mode emphasizes linked audio, field readings, markers and session review. Both share the recording engine and explorable internals.

Skins define appearance

Keep the Winamp-inspired skin idea on the future design list. Materials, colors and meter styling can vary without making a skin responsible for functional differences. A classic audio user should have a clear home.

The flip preserves a physical relationship

The front and back feel like two sides of the same instrument. Flipping reveals the process already running; it should not interrupt recording. A proposed front-panel indicator identifies an active custom chain.

The back hosts component experimentation

Proposed flow: choose an insertion point, select an available component, inspect its controls, bypass for comparison, and move or remove it where supported. Before/after placement can change the result; supported insertion points must come from the engine contract.

Still open: default-mode selection, skin system scope, exact navigation, store placement, and the limits of live editing. The mockups are exploratory design references rather than a screen specification.

A recording becomes a documented session

One elapsed timeline

Audio, sensor samples, event markers and setting changes should map to a common session clock. Voice-activated recording may skip silence: preserve those gaps through explicit timing metadata rather than compressing the session history.

Preserve captured and processed sound

Retain original microphone audio alongside the emulated or effect-processed result. Save the active chain and settings; timestamp changes during a session so later listeners can understand what processing was applied.

Capture context and availability

Candidate tracks: magnetic field, motion and pressure where supported. Record device identity, units, sampling information, sensor accuracy/status where provided, missing data and interruptions. Exact platform access and device support need technical validation.

Review with a shared cursor

Select an interesting sound and inspect the phone measurements at that moment. Show movement and capture gaps alongside other readings. Coincidence is something to examine; the interface should not label it proof of a paranormal cause.

Implementation questions: clock mapping and drift, battery and storage cost, permission flows, background behavior, synchronization accuracy, export format and the interaction between voice activation and raw-audio retention.

A complete instrument, then new equipment

Free scope / agreed principle

The free app contains the good stuff: Recorder and Investigation modes, sensor-session functionality, watching the internals, and the adjustments already intended for users in the engine. Do not infer that all tinkering is paid.

Paid scope / direction, not a final catalog

Additional components arrive in packages that enable a worthwhile new experience. Examples discussed include equalization, reverb, flanging and more unusual sound processing. Specific products, prices and package contents are undecided.

Bundle shape / working proposal

Several complementary processors plus example chains and presets offer an immediate starting point. Users can listen, compare, take the chain apart and build their own. One purchase should feel like opening a useful box of equipment.

Where the experience happens

Added components appear in the same back-panel language as the rest of the instrument. Purchased expansion should feel integrated into the workbench. Which editing capabilities are bundled remains open until the free engine controls are known.

Unresolved: one workbench unlock versus multiple experience packs, future pack access, store presentation and the exact free/paid boundary. No subscription model or pricing has been selected.

Questions for the engine agent

1 / Inventory the controls

List existing parameters, defaults and valid ranges. Separate intended user controls from calibration and implementation settings. Identify which can change during recording.

2 / Expose meaningful activity

Identify per-stage levels, gain reduction, gate/VAS state, clipping and other telemetry available for animation. Define units, update rates and a safe UI delivery mechanism.

3 / Define extension points

Confirm whether modules can be inserted, bypassed, reordered or removed. Specify supported boundaries, latency reporting and whether topology changes require stopping capture.

4 / Support reproducible sessions

Describe raw and processed audio access, voice-activation timing, sample-to-session mapping, chain serialization and parameter-change logging. Propose a versioned session contract.

5 / Establish ownership

Keep phone sensors, permissions, styling and purchase presentation in the app layer unless a shared contract requires otherwise. Return capability facts before locking the UI or commercial boundary.

Next review: map this inventory onto the three visual concepts; confirm supported interactions; prototype the phone layout and telemetry before treating the renderings as an implementation specification.

What the team can rely on

Agreed direction

Phone-first, iPhone before Android; live recording is the core experience. Blend believable internals with a readable signal path. Preserve the original vintage concept as the baseline, add a dedicated Investigation mode, and reserve skins as a later appearance layer.

Agreed value principle

A generous, useful free app, including existing intended user tinkering. Paid packages provide additional experiences through groups of components. Exact technical and commercial boundaries remain open.

Proposals requiring validation

Sensor timing and raw-audio retention, component insertion and routing, live changes, telemetry, session serialization, presets and export. These are design requirements or candidates, not verified engine features.

Source and scope

Prepared from the product-design conversation with Chance Houston on 15 October 2026 and its three generated concept images, embedded here. Repository context: github.com/chancehouston/rr-dr60-emu. No fresh repository implementation audit or platform sensor certification was performed for this dossier.

Use: share as a common design brief for the engine agent and team. The document communicates intent, decisions and unanswered questions; it does not replace the engine inventory or a tested interaction prototype.